



Administrator Certification Program Training Vendors

SAMPLE COURSE OUTLINE

Prepared May 2020

Department of Social Services
Community Care Licensing Division

ADMINISTRATOR CERTIFICATION SECTION VENDOR SUPPORT AND REVIEW UNIT

744 P Street MS 9-17-47, Sacramento, CA 95814
Phone: (916) 653-9300; E-Mail: ACSVendorInfo@dss.ca.gov

SAMPLE COURSE OUTLINE

(Best Practice Model)

Course Description:

This four-hour live course is designed to meet the requirements toward the recertification of Wildlife Professionals. This course will provide a comprehensive overview of the cheetah as a species, including their life cycle, communication, appearance, specialized adaptations, and social system. The course will impress upon the learner the very real threats these animals are facing, specifically threats posed by a small genetic pool, habitat depletion, prey scarcity, and human-induced mortality. Global conservation efforts will be explored, including zoos and their breeding programs, wildlife preserves, and international organizations. The concluding group discussion will focus on what participants themselves can do to help protect the cheetah. Two (2) 10-minute breaks will be provided.

Course Objectives:

Upon completion of this course, participants will be able to:

- 1) Have greater knowledge of the cheetah as a species
- 2) Understand the basic life-cycle of the cheetah
- 3) Identify the four (4) main threats the global cheetah population is facing
- 4) Understand the root causes of decline in cheetah population
- 5) Explain what efforts are being made to keep the cheetah from going extinct

Note(s):

Course objectives should be SMART: Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Realistic, Timely

Course objectives should align with course description and course outline.

Teaching Methods:

Teaching methods will include the use of a PowerPoint presentation and accompanying handouts, with copies of these lecture materials distributed to participants. The handouts can be used for taking notes in class and will be taken home as an educational resource. A short video will be shown to enhance the learning experience. A group discussion, facilitated by the instructor(s), will close out the course.

Note(s):

The best teaching methods are blended to include: PowerPoint presentation, lecture, interactive and group activities, media, etc., especially for day long courses.

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Hand-outs:

- PowerPoint Presentation Printout – space for writing notes
- Big Cats Family Tree - Biological Classification
- Cheetah Infographic - Physiological Traits

Course Content Outline:

Introduction (20 minutes)

12:00 - 12:20

- 1) Introduction of the instructor (John H. Smith or Barbara E. Doe)
 - a. Qualifications
 - b. Experience
- 2) Housekeeping
 - a. Confirm participants are in the correct class
 - b. Go over rules: parking, exits, bathroom locations, break times, returning to the room on time, cell phone usage, side conversations, participation expectation, course evaluation, how the certificate of completion will be distributed
- 3) Brief round table introduction of participants
 - a. Name, job title/where they work
- 4) Discuss Course Objectives – what participants should expect to learn during the course
- 5) Distribute Handouts
 - a. Copy of PowerPoint
 - b. Big Cats Family Tree
 - c. Cheetah Infographic

Species Information (1 hour)

12:20 – 1:20

- 1) Etymology
 - a. Cheetah is derived from the Hindi word “Chita” meaning “Spotted One”
- 2) Classification
 - a. Kingdom: Animal Phylum: Chordata Class: Mammalia Order: Carnivore Family: Felidae
 - i. Subfamily: Acinonychinae
 - ii. Genus: Acinonyx
 - iii. Species: Jubatus
- 3) Characteristics
 - a. Appearance

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- i. Tear-drop shaped black lines from eyes to mouth
 - ii. Tan/yellow-buff colored coat with black spots and a white belly
 - iii. End of tail has dark rings and white tuft
 - iv. Males slightly larger than females
 - v. Size – 3.5 to 4.5 feet from head to rump; tails add additional 25.5-31.5 inches
 - vi. Weight – 77 to 142 pounds
 - b. Morphology – Specialized Adaptations
 - i. Built for speed – narrow lightweight body, long legs, specialized muscles (enlarged heart and lungs), flexible spine, non-retractable claws with hard paw pads for gripping the ground, long flat tail used for stability when making sharp turns at high speeds
 - ii. Head – small, reduced muzzle length, large eyes positioned for binocular vision, enlarged nostrils for increased air intake, black tear-drop markings (keeps sun reflection out of eyes)
 - iii. Brain – small size, small frontal cortex, light weight – requires less energy
 - iv. Water Intake – built for arid land, only needs water every 3-4 days, will also drink blood or urine of prey
- 4) Territory
 - a. The cheetah was once one of the most widely distributed land animals – found in Asia, India, Europe, and Africa
 - b. Now found mostly in five (5) African Countries
 - i. Kenya, Tanzania, Namibia, Botswana, and Zimbabwe
- 5) Habitat
 - a. African
 - i. Sub-Saharan Africa – dry, vast land with abundant prey
 - ii. Namibia – grassland, savannah, dense vegetation, mountainous terrain
 - iii. Other – bush, scrub, open woodlands
- 6) Communication
 - a. Vocalizations – purrs, bleats, hisses, high-pitched chirping, growls
 - b. Marking- cheek/chin rubbing, urine splashes: trees, termite mounds
- 7) Hunting
 - a. Carnivorous – gazelles, impalas, wildebeest calves, smaller hoofed animals, birds, hare
 - b. Diurnal Hunter
- 8) Fastest Land Animal
 - a. Reaches speeds between 70-75 mph, in short bursts
 - b. Ability to accelerate from 0-60 mph in 3 seconds

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c. Video

i: "This Is Why You Can't Outrun a Cheetah"

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V8vejVgIHg>. Running Time: 3:03.

Release Date: 2012. Produced by: The Smithsonian Channel.

ii. Feedback from participants (5 minutes)

Break (10 minutes)

1:20 – 1:30

Life Cycle of the Cheetah (1 hour)

1:30 – 2:30

1) Mating

a. Sexual Maturity

i. Females – between 20 and 24 months

ii. Males – between 2 and 3 years

iii. Courtship – up to 3 days, males leave after mating and do not participate in cub rearing

2) Birth

a. Gestation period of 90-95 days

i. Usual litter size: 3-5 cubs

ii. Largest ever recorded in captivity: 8

b. Weight at birth – 5 to 10 ounces, born blind

3) Cubs

a. Initial Stages of Development

i. Open eyes: 4-14 days

ii. First tooth: 3 weeks

iii. Milk teeth: 6 weeks

iv. Permanent teeth: 8 months

v. Walking: starts at 3 weeks

vi. Nursing: 2-3 months but weaning starts at 6 weeks

b. Appearance

i. Born with mantle of fur running down spine for camouflage

ii. Newborn fur color is medium gray, adult fur coloring by 4 months

c. Mortality Rate

i. Very high – up to 90% of cubs will die within the first year

4) 40% die due to lack of genetic diversity (history of inbreeding, weak/underdeveloped immune system, low resistance to disease)

5) 50% fall prey to predators such as lions, hyenas, and eagles

6) Mother's Role

a. Will leave for up to 48 hours at a time to find food

b. Will move cubs often to avoid predators

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- c. If food supply is too scarce – may abandon cubs
 - d. If an entire litter is lost within a few weeks of birth – the female will enter into estrus (heat) again
 - e. If the mother dies – cubs attempt to find a different family group to join
- 7) Juveniles
- a. Play
 - i. 5 months – sharpens stalking and chasing skills, wrestling
 - ii. 6 months – mother will bring back injured live prey
 - iii. 8 months – chasing after prey independently
 - iv. 9-14 months – will be around 10% successful in the hunt
 - v. 15-24 months – leaves the mother, but will stay with sibling group
- 8) Adults
- a. Females
 - i. Leaves any brothers when they reach sexual maturity
 - ii. Solitary – tends to avoid other cheetahs (minority form mother/daughter pairs)
 - iii. Tends to stay close to home and may overlap territory with their mother, called a “home range”, size depends on availability of prey
 - iv. Mating occurs throughout the year, cub rearing happens independently, however some females may choose to live near other family units
 - b. Males
 - i. Males will travel far to claim territory
 - ii. Forms coalition with other males (typically brothers), 30% of coalitions are of unrelated males
 - iii. Claims territory as large as 300-800 square miles, not territorial with members of their own coalition
 - iv. Very territorial against male outsiders/rivals
 - v. Outcome of males fighting each other – leaves 1 male for every 2 females
- 9) Life Expectancy
- a. Wild – 10-12 years
- 10) Captivity – up to 20 years

Break (10 minutes)

2:30 – 2:40

Four Global Threats to the Cheetah Population (30 minutes)

2:40 – 3:10

- 1) Genetics
 - a. Wild Populations
 - i. Low genetic diversity

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- ii. Inbreeding
 - iii. Susceptibility to ecological and environmental changes
 - iv. Vulnerability to viral and parasitic epizootics – affects genetically uniform populations
 - b. Captive Populations
 - i. Highly susceptible to diseases: glomerulosclerosis, amyloidosis, helicobacter associated gastritis, veno-occlusive disease, focalpalatine erosion, lymphoplasmacytic gastritis
 - ii. Neurological: leukoencephalopathy
 - iii. Adults: progressive hind-limb paralysis
 - iv. Cubs: acute hind-limb ataxia, spongiform encephalopathy
 - v. Breeding: poorly in captivity – wild populations have been sustaining captive ones (more than 90% of cheetahs in captivity are traced back to Namibia)
- 2) Habitat
 - a. Alteration
 - i. Fragmentation resulting from human development – leads to inbreeding
 - b. Removal
 - i. Semi-arid habitat is degrading
 - ii. Land turns into desert
 - iii. Agriculture
 - iv. Industries
 - v. Human settlements
 - vi. Mining
 - vii. Infrastructure
- 3) Prey Scarcity
 - a. Livestock
 - i. Competes with native animals for resources – water, food, space
 - ii. Native species populations decline
 - b. Cheetahs forced to prey on livestock
- 4) Human-Induced Mortality
 - a. Hunting
 - i. Big game hunting
 - ii. Sport-killing
 - iii. Cheetah trophy hunting permitted in: Namibia, Zambia, and Zimbabwe
 - b. Poaching
 - i. Rural poverty, few employment opportunities, slack surveillance, multiple routes out of the country, lax court punishment
 - ii. Poaching gangs – organized crime syndicates, ties to terrorism funding
 - iii. Insiders benefit monetarily by looking the other way

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- iv. Capturing cubs – smuggled out to be kept as pets
- c) Fur
 - i. Illegal fur trade
 - ii. Desirability of pelts as a status symbol
- d) Conflict with Farmers
 - i. Cheetahs are driven to farms in search of prey
 - ii. Lack of livestock management in Africa – low governmental oversight
 - iii. Ranchers shoot to kill – 10,000 cheetahs killed between 1980 and 1991

Conservation Efforts (20 minutes)

3:10 – 3:30

- 1) Statistics
 - a. International Union for the Conservation of Nature (IUCN) Red List, lists the cheetah as:
 - i. Least Concern
 - ii. Near Threatened
 - iii. Vulnerable
 - iv. Endangered
 - i. Critically Endangered
 - i. Extinct in the Wild
 - ii. Extinct
 - a. International calls to move the cheetah to “endangered” – only 7,100 left in the wild as of 2016
- 2) Zoos
 - a. Breeding programs – mostly poor outcomes
- 3) Sharing knowledge about: animal behavior, reproduction, ecology, genetics, species sustainability
- 4) Wildlife Preserves – Africa
 - a. Serengeti-Masai Mara Ecosystem
 - b. Greater Limpopo Transfrontier Park
 - c. Selous Game Reserve
 - d. Etosha National Park
 - e. Chobe National Park
- 5) International Organizations
 - a. Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species (CITES)
 - b. African Wildlife Foundation
 - c. Cheetah Conservation Fund
 - i. Cheetah Conservation Botswana – aims to preserve native cheetah population through: scientific research, community outreach, education, and working with rural communities to promote

- coexistence
- d. Cat Ambassador Program – The Angel Fund
- e. Clinton Global Initiative - \$80 million invested in a multi-stakeholder project to eliminate poaching

Group Discussion – What You Can Do (20 minutes)

3:30 – 3:50

- 1) Instructor asks participants how they can help to save the cheetah
- 2) Examples of conversation topics:
 - a. Calls to end big game/big cat hunting
 - i. Pressure on governments to condemn activity
 - ii. Boycotts
 - b. Improve the lives of citizens so they are not driven to poaching/smuggling
 - i. Education
 - ii. Employment opportunities, regional stability
 - c. Charity drives/campaigns
 - d. Social Media

Wrap Up (10 minutes)

3:50 – 4:00

- 1) Distribute course evaluations
- 2) Collect course evaluations
- 3) Certificates of Completion – distribution or how/when to collect

Sources:

“Big Cats” Biological Classification. Bigcatwildcats.com/wp-content/uploads/2012/05/bigcatsbiologicalclassification-1.jpg.

Bradford, Alina. “Cheetahs: Facts, Pictures & Habitat.” Live Science, 16 Oct. 2014, www.livescience.com/27319-cheetahs.html.

“Cheetah.” Animals, National Geographic, 2015, www.nationalgeographic.com/animals/mammals/c/cheetah/.

Cheetah Built for Speed. www.thomsonsafaris.com/blog/wp-content/uploads/2012/12/cheetah_speed.jpg

“Cheetah Facts.” Caring for Cats & Ending the Trade, Big Cat Rescue, 2015, Bigcatrescue.org/cheetah-facts/.

Cheetahs: A Predator’s Role in the Ecosystem. Cheetah Conservation Fund, 2014, Cheetah.org/site/wp-content/uploads/2014/02/TeacherGuide_life_Cycle.pdf

Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora. www.cites.org/eng

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Durant, S., Mitchell, N., Ipavec, A. & Groom, R. 2015. *Acinonyx jubatus*. The IUCN Red List of Threatened Species 2015: e.T219A50649567. <http://dx.doi.org/10.2305/IUCN.UK.2015-4.RLTS.T219A50649567.en>.

Fitzgerald, Jakob, and Amir Alsaffar. "Cheetah (*Acinonyx jubatus*)." Tree of Life Project, 2008, Tolweb.org/treehouses/?treehouse_id=4830.

Largo, Verity. "Poaching – the cheetahs of the Serengeti face extinction." The Ecologist, 16 Nov. 2013, www.theecologist.org/News/news_analysis/2160077/poaching_the_cheetahs_of_the_serengeti_face_extinction.html.

Species information – Cheetah. Cat Specialist Group – The World Conservation Union, www.Catsg.org/cheetah/01_information/1_2_species-information/species-information.htm.

"Wildlife in Africa." The Safari Company, thesafaricompany.co.za/Wildlife_in_Africa.htm.

Method of Course Evaluation by Participants:

At the end of the course, participants will have the opportunity to evaluate the course as well as the individual instructors. *Please see the enclosed evaluation sheet.*

Method of Evaluating Participants – Best Practice: Examples:

- Pre-test (submit questions with answers)
- Post-test (submit question with answers)
- Open Discussion (submit questions with desired responses)

How well the participants are able to answer questions and contribute to discussions, enables the instructor to evaluate the participant's achievement of course objectives.

Records Maintained at (Street Address, City, State, Zip Code):

The following records shall be maintained:

1. Course Schedules, Dates, and Descriptions
2. Course Outlines
3. Lists of Instructors and Resumes
4. Rosters of Participants (LIC 9142A or facsimile)
5. Course Evaluations by Participants
6. Documentation of Participant Course Completion

Location of Course:

123 Any Street, Suite 500 Sacramento, CA 95814